



DESKTOP ICON MANAGER

User Manual

Version 1.6.7

Save and restore your desktop icon layout — across one monitor or several, at any resolution.

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	2
1. Welcome	4
Requirements	4
2. Getting Started	5
First Launch	5
The Main Window	5
3. Saving and Restoring Layouts	7
3.1 Save Current Layout	7
3.2 Restore	7
3.2.1 Restore Preview	7
3.2.2 Restore Just One Display	8
3.2.3 New Icons Found During Restore	8
3.3 Auto-saved Layouts	8
3.4 Managing Layouts	9
3.5 Version History	9
3.6 Search, Sort, and Filter	9
3.7 Compare Layouts	10
3.8 Bulk Export, Import, and Retention	10
3.9 Original Desktop Layout	11
4. Icon Tools	12
4.1 Align and Sort (Arrange ■ on the Layouts toolbar)	12
4.2 Icon Size (Arrange ■ on the Layouts toolbar)	12
4.3 Recover Off-screen Icons (Icon Tools, sidebar)	12
4.4 Broken Shortcut Scanner (Icon Tools, sidebar)	13
4.5 Duplicate Shortcut Scanner (Icon Tools, sidebar)	13
4.6 Hide / Show Icons (Icon Tools, sidebar)	13
4.7 Undo	13

5. Automation	14
5.1 Auto-restore on Display Change	14
5.2 Auto-save	14
5.3 Run at Windows Startup	14
5.4 Global Hotkeys	14
6. Options	16
General	16
License Information	16
7. System Tray	16
8. Scripting & Reliability	17
Reliability	17
9. Security & License	18
10. Troubleshooting	19
11. Version History	21

1. Welcome

Desktop Icon Manager saves exactly where your desktop icons are — and restores them later, even after a monitor gets unplugged, a laptop leaves its dock, or Windows changes your display resolution. Every saved layout is tagged with the monitor arrangement it was captured under, so restoring picks the right layout for whatever screens are connected right now, and can remap positions when the arrangement has changed instead of just giving up.

Beyond save/restore, it's a small toolbox for the everyday things that go wrong with desktop icons: sorting and aligning, nudging icon size, finding shortcuts that no longer point anywhere, and pulling back icons that have drifted off the visible screen.

Good to know: Every change this app makes — a restore, a sort, an icon-size nudge, even an appearance change in Options — can be undone with one click. See [4.7 Undo](#).

Requirements

Operating system	Windows 10 or 11
Permissions	None — runs entirely as your own user, no admin rights needed to install or run
Monitors	Any number, any mix of resolutions and positions

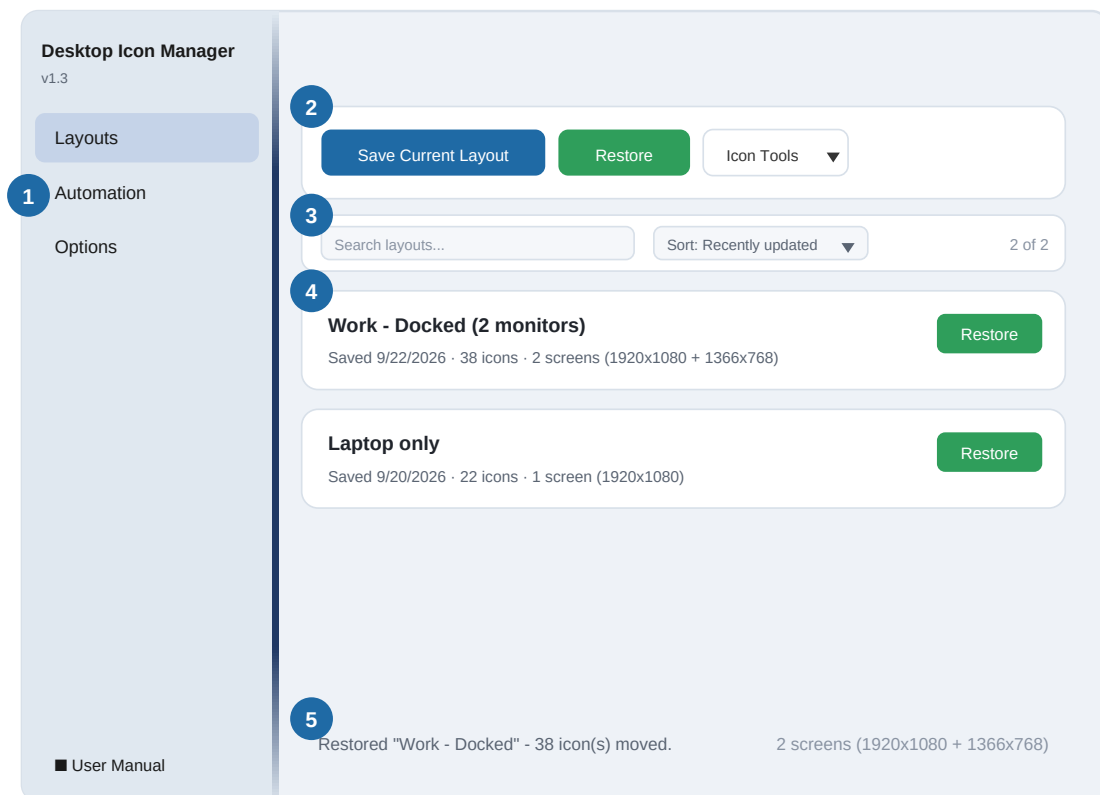
2. Getting Started

First Launch

- Launch **Desktop Icon Manager**. The main window opens to the Welcome page — click a card there, or a section in the sidebar, to get started.
- On the Layouts page, arrange your desktop icons the way you want them, then click **Save Current Layout** and give it a name — that's your first saved layout.
- From then on, whenever your monitor setup changes and your icons end up scattered, click **Restore** on the layout that matches, or let Automation do it for you (see Chapter 5).

The Main Window

A sidebar on the left switches between the app's sections — Layouts, Automation, and Options — each in its own full-size panel on the right, the same left-nav layout used by other tools in this family. The app opens to a Welcome page with a card for each section; click the logo at the top of the sidebar any time to get back to it — it doesn't have its own sidebar button, since the logo already does that job. The Layouts page has a toolbar for saving, restoring, and icon tools, plus a card for every saved layout; a status bar at the bottom of the content area, shared by every page, shows the last action taken and your current monitor setup, and Undo — when there's something to undo — appears at the bottom of the sidebar so it's reachable no matter which page you're on.



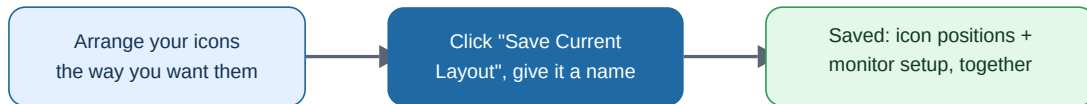
The main window: (1) sidebar navigation — Layouts, Automation, Options, (2) the Layouts page's toolbar, (3) the search and sort bar (3.6), (4) a saved layout's card with its own Restore button, (5) the shared status bar showing the last action taken and the current monitor setup.

Closing the window minimizes it to the system tray rather than exiting — Automation (auto-restore on display change, scheduled auto-save) keeps running quietly in the background. Right-click the tray icon for Show/Restore/Quit, or use Options to change what closing the window does.

3. Saving and Restoring Layouts

This is the core of the app — capture where every icon sits, and put them back later.

Saving



Restoring



Icons are matched by name, so a saved layout still restores correctly even after a shortcut has been renamed, and even onto a different monitor arrangement than it was saved under.

Icons are matched by name, so a saved layout still restores correctly even after a shortcut has been renamed, and even onto a different monitor arrangement than it was saved under.

3.1 Save Current Layout

Captures the position of every icon on your desktop right now, together with a signature of your current monitor arrangement (resolution, position, and count for each screen). Click **Save Current Layout**, type a name, and it appears as a new card in the list.

3.2 Restore

Click **Restore** on any layout's card to move every icon back to its saved position. If the layout's saved monitor signature matches your current setup exactly, positions are applied as-is. If it doesn't — a monitor is missing, or the resolution has changed — the app remaps each icon's position proportionally onto the screens you have now, so icons still land in roughly the right place rather than off-screen or overlapping.

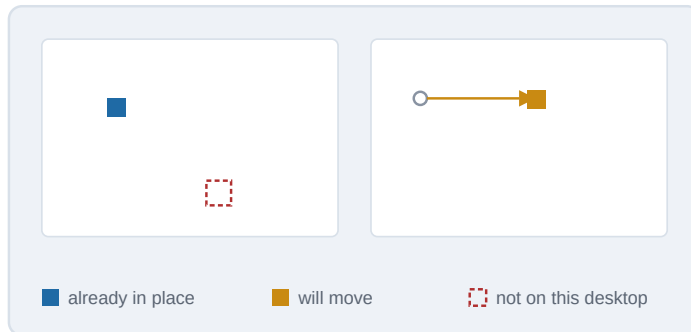
Tip: A card showing the **Matches current setup** badge was saved under the exact monitor arrangement you have right now — that's always the safest one to restore.

Safety net: Your current icon positions are saved automatically before a restore runs, so **Undo** can always put things back the way they were a moment ago.

3.2.1 Restore Preview

Before anything actually moves, the restore confirmation shows a color-coded preview of what's about to happen — every icon in the layout, marked as already in place, about to move, or not currently on the desktop at all.

Restore preview



Shown before every restore

A quick before-and-after, so you always know what a restore is about to do before it happens.

More than one monitor?

Checkboxes above the preview let you restore just one display, leaving the others untouched.

Icons are matched by name, exactly like the actual restore - what you see here is what will happen.

The restore preview: flat blue for no change, a plain amber arrow from where an icon is now to where it's headed, and a dashed red outline for something the layout expects that isn't on the desktop right now.

A small legend under the preview totals each category, so you can tell at a glance whether a restore is going to be a minor tidy-up or move most of the desktop.

3.2.2 Restore Just One Display

With more than one monitor connected, the restore confirmation also lists each current display with its own checkbox, all checked by default. Uncheck a display to leave whatever's on it alone — useful when only one screen's arrangement actually got messed up and the others are already fine.

Note: This filters by where an icon is *headed*, not where it started — an icon moving from Display 1 onto Display 2 in the saved layout is restored or skipped based on Display 2's checkbox.

3.2.3 New Icons Found During Restore

If your desktop has icons that weren't part of the layout when it was saved — something you added, or copied over from another machine — Restore notices them and, once it's done, asks whether to save the current arrangement as the new version of this layout so they're included from now on.

A new icon is left exactly where you put it — **unless** it happens to be sitting exactly on a spot a saved icon needs to move back to. In that one case, Restore moves the new icon to the next free spot on the same desktop to make room, and tells you it did so, naming the icon(s) it moved.

Note: This is the only case a new icon is ever moved. It's never deleted or renamed, and every other new icon — not blocking anything — is left untouched. Asking to save the current arrangement afterward is a separate question, offered whether or not anything needed to be nudged aside.

3.3 Auto-saved Layouts

A card badged **Auto-saved** was captured automatically — either by the periodic Auto-save timer or right before an automatic restore — rather than by clicking Save yourself. It behaves exactly like a manually

saved layout otherwise: restore it, rename it, or delete it the same way.

3.4 Managing Layouts

Click the  menu on any layout's card for more options:

Restore	Same as the card's Restore button
Update with Current Icon Positions	Overwrites this layout with where your icons are right now
Rename	Change the layout's name
Duplicate	Makes a copy under a new name
Version History	Browse and restore earlier saved versions of this layout — see 3.5
Compare with...	Diff this layout against another saved layout — see 3.7
Export to file...	Saves this layout as a standalone file you can back up or move to another machine
Delete	Removes the layout permanently

Use **Import** ▼, in the main toolbar, to bring in a layout someone exported (or one you exported from this same machine earlier) as a new card in the list — see 3.8 for bringing in several layouts at once from a backup ZIP.

3.5 Version History

Every time a layout is re-saved — manually updated, or auto-saved over — its previous state is kept as an earlier version rather than simply overwritten. Open **Version History** from a layout's  menu to see that build-up of versions and restore any one of them, in case the most recent save wasn't the one you actually wanted.

3.6 Search, Sort, and Filter

Once you've saved more than a handful of layouts, the bar above the list helps you find the one you want. Type into **Search layouts by name...** to filter the list as you type, and use the **Sort by** menu to reorder it:

Recently updated	The default — newest changes first
Name (A–Z)	Alphabetical by layout name
Resolution	Largest total screen area first — a multi-monitor layout sorts above a single-monitor one

Icon count	Layouts with the most icons first
-------------------	-----------------------------------

A count under the search bar (for example “3 of 12 layouts”) shows how many layouts are currently visible versus how many exist in total.

3.7 Compare Layouts

Choose **Compare with...** from a layout's  menu, then pick a second saved layout, to see how the two differ without restoring either one. The comparison uses the same color-coded preview as a restore, plus two categories a restore preview doesn't need — an icon that only exists in one of the two layouts:

In both	Same position in both layouts (within a couple of pixels)
Moved	Present in both, but at a different position
Only in the first layout	Shown with a dashed outline
Only in the second layout	Shown filled in

Note: If the two layouts were saved under different monitor arrangements, the first layout's positions are best-effort translated onto the second layout's screens before comparing — the same remapping a restore uses.

Comparing is purely informational — nothing on your desktop changes. A **Restore** shortcut for either layout is available right from the comparison if you decide to act on what you see.

3.8 Bulk Export, Import, and Retention

Beyond exporting one layout at a time, **Export All...** in the main toolbar saves every layout into a single backup ZIP file. The **Import ▼** button accepts either kind of file back in:

Import layout file (.dimlayout)...	Brings in one previously exported layout
Import backup ZIP...	Brings in every layout from a backup ZIP at once

A ZIP import skips any layout that's an exact duplicate of one you already have (same name, same monitor signature, same icon positions), and automatically renames anything else that collides with an existing layout's name, so importing the same backup twice is always safe.

To keep old auto-saves and backups from piling up indefinitely, **Options** → **Keep at most** lets you cap how many layouts are kept — *Unlimited* (the default), or a limit of 10, 25, or 50. Once a limit is set, the oldest layouts beyond that count are removed automatically each time a new one is saved or imported, oldest first.

Safety net: A retention limit removes layouts, not the desktop icons they describe — your actual desktop is never touched by this setting. The one exception is the **Protected** "Original Desktop Layout" described next (3.9) — it's never counted or removed by a retention limit.

3.9 Original Desktop Layout

The very first time the app is ever run, it silently saves the desktop exactly as it already was — before you've clicked anything — as a layout named **Original Desktop Layout**, badged **Protected**. It's a permanent fallback: if a later restore or Windows itself ever scrambles things and nothing else saved looks right, this is always there to go back to.

This only ever happens once, on a genuinely first-ever launch — installing an update on top of an existing install never triggers it again, since it checks whether the app has saved a config before, not just whether this particular layout exists yet. A Protected layout behaves like any other otherwise — it can be restored, renamed, or deleted like normal — it's just exempted from the retention limit above (3.8) so it can't quietly age out.

4. Icon Tools

Everyday icon housekeeping that has nothing to do with saved layouts, split across two places (as of v1.6.3): quick arranging actions (4.1–4.2) live in the **Arrange ▼** menu on the Layouts page's own toolbar, since they're something you'd reach for while looking at a layout; the standalone repair/cleanup tools (4.3–4.6) got their own **Icon Tools** section in the sidebar on the left, since they're not really about any one layout.

4.1 Align and Sort (Arrange ▼ on the Layouts toolbar)

Align to grid	Snaps every icon to the nearest position on Windows' own icon grid, without changing which icon is where
Sort by name	Rearranges icons alphabetically
Sort by type	Groups icons by file type — a shortcut that can't be resolved to a real file sorts to the end, by name
Sort by date modified	Orders icons by when their target file was last modified — same best-effort fallback as Sort by type for unresolvable shortcuts
Sort by size	Orders icons largest-file-first; a folder shortcut sorts by name within its group rather than walking its contents for a total size

Note: If “**Auto arrange icons**” is turned on in Windows, Explorer will keep re-arranging icons on its own after this app moves them — turn that Windows setting off first (right-click the desktop → View) if you want positions to stick.

Tip: Turn on “**Sort folders first**” in Options to always group folder shortcuts ahead of files, whichever of the sorts above you use.

4.2 Icon Size (Arrange ▼ on the Layouts toolbar)

Icon size: smaller and **Icon size: larger** nudge the desktop icon size up or down one step at a time — the same effect as holding Ctrl and scrolling the mouse wheel on the desktop. Windows doesn't expose fixed small/medium/large presets programmatically, so this is a relative nudge rather than a jump to an exact size; repeat the click to keep stepping.

4.3 Recover Off-screen Icons (Icon Tools, sidebar)

If a monitor was unplugged while icons were sitting on it, those icons can end up positioned outside the visible desktop area — present, but impossible to see or click. **Recover off-screen icons** finds any icon outside the current screen bounds and moves it back into view.

4.4 Broken Shortcut Scanner (Icon Tools, sidebar)

Scan for broken shortcuts checks every shortcut on your desktop and lists the ones whose target no longer exists — moved, renamed, or deleted. Review the list, check the ones you want gone, and click **Delete Selected (to Recycle Bin)**; nothing is permanently deleted, since it goes to the Recycle Bin like any normal delete and can be restored from there.

4.5 Duplicate Shortcut Scanner (Icon Tools, sidebar)

Find duplicate shortcuts groups every shortcut on your desktop by what it actually points at, and flags any group with more than one — usually a second copy dragged from the Start menu, or a leftover from reinstalling something. Within each group the first shortcut is left unchecked and the rest are pre-checked as likely extras; review before deleting. Deleting goes to the Recycle Bin, same as the Broken Shortcut Scanner.

4.6 Hide / Show Icons (Icon Tools, sidebar)

Hide/show icons lets you tuck icons out of sight without deleting or moving them anywhere. Check any icon under “Icons on your desktop” and click **Hide Selected** — those icons disappear from the desktop the same way any hidden file does in Windows. To bring one back, reopen this tool, check it under “Hidden icons”, and click **Show Selected**.

Note: This uses Windows' own Hidden file attribute — the same thing Explorer's own “Hide selected items” does — so a hidden icon is only actually invisible while Windows' “Show hidden files, folders, and drives” setting is off, which is the Windows default.

4.7 Undo

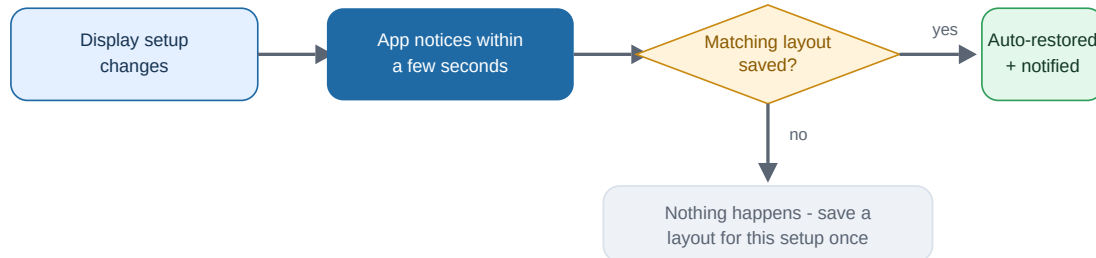
The **Undo** button at the bottom of the sidebar — visible on every page, not just Layouts — reverses the most recent change, whatever kind it was — restoring a layout, an align/sort, an icon-size nudge, or an appearance/spacing change made in Options. It shows a short label naming what it's about to undo, and only appears when there's something to undo. Desktop Icon Manager keeps the last 10 changes, so you can step back through more than just the very last action if needed.

Anything you can screw up, you can undo: This is the answer to “I clicked something and now it looks wrong” — whatever it was, Undo can put it back.

5. Automation

Click **Automation** in the sidebar to have Desktop Icon Manager look after itself in the background.

Auto-restore on display change



Auto-save



Both features run quietly in the background from the system tray - closing the window minimizes it there.

Both features run quietly in the background from the system tray — closing the window minimizes it there rather than exiting.

5.1 Auto-restore on Display Change

When turned on, the app notices within a few seconds any time your monitor arrangement changes — docking or undocking a laptop, plugging in or removing a monitor, a resolution change — and automatically restores whichever saved layout matches the new arrangement. If nothing matches, nothing happens; save a layout for that setup once and it will be picked up automatically from then on. Turn on **Show a notification when this happens** to get a quick heads-up each time it fires.

5.2 Auto-save

When turned on, the app periodically snapshots your current icon positions as an **Auto-saved** layout for whatever monitor setup is active, on the interval you set. This means there's usually a recent, matching layout available even if you never click Save yourself.

5.3 Run at Windows Startup

Available from **Options** (not Automation) — check “**Run Desktop Icon Manager when Windows starts**” to have it launch automatically at sign-in, usually starting minimized to the tray so it's ready to auto-restore your layout the moment your monitors are detected. This is a per-user setting written to your own Windows startup entry — no admin rights are needed.

5.4 Global Hotkeys

Turn on **Enable hotkeys** in Automation to trigger Save or Restore from anywhere in Windows, without bringing the app window to the front first — useful right after re-docking or plugging in a monitor. Set your own key combinations for **Quick save** and **Quick restore**, for example:

Quick save	ctrl+alt+s (example — set your own combination)
Quick restore	ctrl+alt+r (example — set your own combination)

Tip: Quick restore restores whichever saved layout currently matches your monitor setup — the same one Auto-restore would pick.

6. Options

General

Appearance	System (follows Windows), Light, or Dark
Confirm before restoring a layout	Shows a confirmation dialog before every restore
Minimize to the system tray instead of closing	Controls what the window's close button does
Start minimized to the tray	Skips showing the window on launch — useful together with Run at Windows startup
Icon spacing	Adjusts the horizontal/vertical gap Windows uses between desktop icons
Sort folders first	Applies to every sort in the Arrange ▼ menu — see 4.1
Run Desktop Icon Manager when Windows starts	See 6.3
Keep at most	Caps how many saved layouts are kept — see 3.8

Changes to appearance and icon spacing preview live as you adjust them; clicking **Cancel** reverts any live preview, and clicking **Save** pushes an Undo entry so the whole bundle of changes can be reversed in one click from the main window if needed.

License Information

A **License Information** link at the bottom of Options opens the full license text for this software — see Chapter 10, Security & License.

7. System Tray

By default, closing the main window minimizes Desktop Icon Manager to the system tray rather than exiting it, so Automation keeps running. Right-click (or double-click to show/restore) the tray icon for Show, Restore, and Quit.

Show / double-click	Brings the main window back
Quit	Exits the app completely, stopping Automation until it's launched again

8. Scripting & Reliability

Desktop Icon Manager.exe also understands three command-line options, for scheduled tasks, keyboard-shortcut launchers, or other scripts that need to save or restore a layout without opening any window.

--list	Prints every saved layout's name, one per line, and exits
--backup ["Layout Name"]	Saves the desktop's current icon positions as a new layout — the same capture Save Current Layout does — and exits. The name is optional; leave it off for the same auto-generated name a plain Save would use
--restore "Layout Name"	Restores that layout headlessly — same matching and best-effort remapping the Restore button uses — and exits

These run even while the normal windowed app is already open — a scheduled task or hotkey calling Desktop Icon Manager.exe --restore "Docked" doesn't need to check whether the app is running first.

Example: from a Command Prompt or a shortcut's Target field, quote the layout name if it contains spaces:

```
"C:\Projects\Desktop Icon Manager\Desktop Icon Manager.exe" --restore "Office Dock"
```

A scheduled task that runs a nightly headless backup, for example, could call:

```
"C:\Projects\Desktop Icon Manager\Desktop Icon Manager.exe" --backup "Nightly Backup"
```

Note: A layout saved with --backup is indistinguishable from one saved by clicking Save Current Layout in the app — it shows up as an ordinary manual layout, subject to the same **Keep at most** retention limit (see 7) if one is set.

Reliability

Settings and layouts are written to disk atomically — the app always writes a complete new file and swaps it in, so a crash, power loss, or a sync client locking the file mid-write can't leave a half-written, corrupted file behind. A backup copy of each file is kept alongside it and used automatically to recover if the main copy is ever found to be damaged when the app starts.

If a second copy of Desktop Icon Manager is launched while one is already running — including via a shortcut, a startup entry, or a double-click on the exe — it no longer just shows a message and exits: it signals the already-running copy to come to the front and show itself instead, the same as clicking the tray icon.

9. Security & License

The compiled application includes tamper/decompilation detection. If it notices it's being run under a debugger, or launched by a known disassembler, decompiler, or AI-assisted reverse-engineering tool, a full-screen warning appears showing the machine name and timestamp, and the app exits rather than continuing to run.

This software is free to install, run, use, and share as unmodified copies, on any number of devices, at no charge — but it is licensed, not sold: it may not be modified, decompiled, reverse-engineered, or sold/rented/charged for, including with the assistance of AI-based tools, without the prior written consent of the copyright holder, Beeran Rampersad. The complete license text is always available from **Options** → **License Information** inside the app.

10. Troubleshooting

Restore didn't move any icons

Check the status bar — if it says the layout was saved for a different monitor setup, the app used best-effort remapping. If “Auto arrange icons” is on in Windows (right-click the desktop → View), turn it off; Explorer will otherwise keep re-arranging icons right after this app moves them.

A layout's “Matches current setup” badge disappeared

Your monitor arrangement (resolution, position, or number of screens) has changed since that layout was saved. Restoring will still work — it remaps positions proportionally onto your current screens instead of an exact match.

Icon size buttons don't reach the exact size I want

Icon size: smaller / larger step one notch at a time, the same as Ctrl+scroll wheel on the desktop — click repeatedly to keep stepping toward the size you want.

Sort by type / Sort by date modified put some icons at the end

Those icons' shortcuts couldn't be resolved to a real file on disk (a broken shortcut, or a virtual/system icon) — they're sorted last, by name, as a best-effort fallback rather than being left out.

Auto-restore isn't firing when I dock/undock

Confirm it's turned on in Automation, and that a saved layout exists whose monitor signature matches the new arrangement — with no match, nothing happens by design (save one for that setup once).

The app isn't launching at Windows startup

Check Options → “Run Desktop Icon Manager when Windows starts” is checked. This writes a per-user startup entry, so it needs to be re-checked if the app was reinstalled to a different location.

Global hotkeys aren't responding

Confirm “Enable hotkeys” is checked in Automation, and that the key combination isn't already claimed by another app or by Windows itself — try a different combination if so.

I made a change I didn't mean to

Click Undo at the bottom of the sidebar — it's visible on every page and reverses the most recent change of any kind (restore, sort/align, icon size, or an Options appearance/spacing change), and keeps the last 10 changes so you can step back further if needed.

A security warning filled the whole screen

This means the app detected a debugger or a known reverse-engineering tool attached to its process. Close it and run the installed application normally; contact Beeran Rampersad if you believe this happened in error.

A --restore command says no layout by that name

Layout names are matched case-insensitively but must otherwise match exactly — run `--list` first to see the exact saved names, and quote the name if it contains spaces.

Launching the app again didn't show a second window

That's expected — Desktop Icon Manager only ever runs one copy at a time. A second launch just brings the already-running window to the front, the same as clicking its tray icon.

config.json or a layout looked reset to defaults after a crash

The app recovers automatically from its own backup copy when the main file is damaged, and only falls back to defaults if both copies are unreadable — check `desktop_icon_manager.log` next to the app for a recovery warning if this happens.

An old layout disappeared after saving or importing a new one

Check Options → Keep at most — if a retention limit is set, the oldest layouts beyond that count are removed automatically each time a new one is saved, backed up, or imported. Set it back to Unlimited to stop this.

Importing a backup ZIP said some layouts were skipped

That's expected — an exact duplicate of a layout you already have (same name, monitor setup, and icon positions) is skipped rather than imported a second time. Anything that collides on name only, without matching content, is imported anyway under a renamed copy.

11. Version History

v1.6.7

Fixed an update-install problem: reinstalling over a running copy could get stuck at Setup's "close applications" prompt if Automation and "minimize to tray" were both on. The installer now asks a running copy to actually exit before it checks for anything locked, so that prompt shouldn't appear at all in the normal case.

v1.6.6

The very first time the app is ever run, it now silently saves the desktop exactly as it was as a Protected layout called "Original Desktop Layout" — a permanent fallback that's never removed by a retention limit. See 3.9.

v1.6.5

Updated the software license from free-to-use/no-redistribution to free-to-use-and-share: unmodified copies can now be shared with anyone at no charge, same as Family Vault's license. Still not permitted, without written consent: modifying it, decompiling or reverse-engineering it, or selling/renting/charging for it. See Options → License Information for the full text.

v1.6.4

The Hide/Show Icons tool used to rebuild both of its lists from scratch after every single Hide or Show — correct, but visibly flickered on a desktop with a lot of icons. It now just moves the one icon that changed, so hiding or showing something feels instant.

v1.6.3

Split the old "Icon Tools ▼" toolbar menu in two. Align to grid, the four Sort by options, and the two Icon size options stayed on the Layouts page, renamed to "Arrange ▼" — they're everyday actions for the layout you're looking at. Recover off-screen icons, the Broken Shortcut Scanner, the Duplicate Shortcut Scanner, and Hide/Show Icons moved into a new **Icon Tools** section in the sidebar, since they're one-off repairs, not something tied to any particular layout.

v1.6.2

Brought a narrower version of 1.6.0's new-icon handling back: a new icon on the desktop is still left alone by default, but if it's sitting exactly on the spot a saved icon needs to land on, Restore now moves it aside to the next free spot to make room — and says so, naming the icon(s) it moved. Every other new icon, not in anyone's way, is untouched, same as 1.6.1. Also fixed a long-standing bug in the command-line "--restore" option that would have made it fail on every use.

v1.6.1

1.6.0's "new icons found during restore" feature moved new icons out of the way before the rest of a restore ran. On its first real test it caused a much bigger problem: repositioning those couple of new icons somehow shifted roughly 70 other, completely unrelated icons that were already sitting exactly where they should be. Rather than guess at a fix for something that isn't fully understood, Restore no longer moves new icons at all — it still notices them and still offers to save an updated backup once new ones are found, but the icons themselves are left exactly where they are, full stop.

v1.6.0

Three additions, all from the same “what else can this app do besides restoring icons” conversation: Restore now notices icons that weren't part of a saved layout (added or copied in since), moves them out of the way so they can't block the restore, and offers to fold them into the layout afterward — or says plainly if the desktop's too full to make room. A new Duplicate Shortcut Scanner (Icon Tools) finds shortcuts that point at the exact same thing and helps clean up the extras. And a new Hide/Show Icons tool (Icon Tools) lets you tuck icons out of sight without deleting or moving them, and bring them back later.

v1.5.3

The 1.5.2 fix (park icons off to the side before placing them) turned out not to work the way intended — the desktop doesn't actually have any “off to the side”, so Windows was snapping those icons back onto the visible screen, piling several of them on top of each other. Restore has been rebuilt from scratch around a proper fix: it now works out which icons are actually waiting on each other and moves them in the right order, so nothing ever needs a hiding spot in the first place. It also only touches icons that are actually out of place, instead of nudging every tracked icon every time. And if a handful still can't be placed in one pass, Restore now keeps trying on its own (up to a few times) instead of making you click Restore again yourself.

v1.5.2

Found the actual reason Restore sometimes needed several tries to get every icon right: Windows won't place an icon exactly where another icon is still sitting, so a restore that swaps icons toward each other's spots could leave some short on the first pass, converging a little more with each additional restore. Restore now parks every icon that's about to move out of the way first, so nothing is ever in another icon's way — it should now get everything right in one pass instead of several.

v1.5.1

Fixed Restore sometimes not landing every icon in its saved spot on the first try. Restore now double-checks each icon's position after moving it and retries once if it didn't take, and warns if two icons on the desktop share the same name (Desktop Icon Manager matches icons by name, so two icons named the same thing can't be told apart and will be sent to the same spot). Also fixed a bug that would have crashed the quick-restore hotkey and auto-restore-on-display-change the first time either one ran, once Automation was turned on.

v1.5

Removed Icon Groups. Real-world use surfaced several problems with it at once — icons rendering outside the New Group/Edit Group selection canvas, a region-select drag that didn't capture every icon it visually covered, and deleting a group not restoring icons it had moved despite promising to — serious enough, together, that the feature has been pulled rather than patched further. Nothing else changed; every other feature works exactly as before.

v1.4

Fixed a startup-thread bug that could crash global hotkey registration on launch, and a bad argument that made the Automation page silently fail to open — both found and fixed the day of the app's first real-world launch. Added a Welcome page (shown on launch; click the logo at the top of the sidebar to get back to it any time) with a card for each section. Widened the minimum window size so the Layouts toolbar no longer gets cut off next to the v1.3 sidebar. Changed the software license to free-to-use/no-modification (matching

Beeran's Outlook Tools) and the copyright holder to Beeran Rampersad.

v1.3

Redesigned main window: a left sidebar now switches between four full pages — Layouts, Icon Groups, Automation, and Options — in place of the old single toolbar-and-dialogs layout, with a gradient divider between the sidebar and content, matching the look of other tools in this family. Undo now lives at the bottom of the sidebar so it's reachable from any page. No functional changes — every feature works exactly as before, just reorganized.

v1.2

Icon Groups — draw labeled, colored, collapsible boxes around regions of your desktop to group the real icons inside them; purely visual, nothing is moved and closing the app just stops drawing the boxes, with a choice of three box styles (labeled, outline-only, or invisible) and an optional, fully undoable compact-to-1–4-columns control that shrinks a group to a tight grid and restores every icon to its exact saved spot · Compare Layouts — diff any two saved layouts against each other, independent of what's on the desktop right now · search, sort, and a live count for the saved-layout list · bulk Export All / Import ▼ as a single backup ZIP, with duplicate-skipping on import · an optional **Keep at most** retention limit that automatically trims the oldest layouts · new --backup command-line option for headless, scripted saves.

v1.1

Restore preview now shows a full before/after diagram, color-coded by what will happen to each icon, with optional per-monitor checkboxes to restore just one display · sort by size, and a new “sort folders first” option that applies to every sort · reliability hardening — settings and layouts are now written atomically with an automatic backup-and-recover path · launching a second copy now brings the running window forward instead of just showing a message · new --list / --restore command-line options for scripted, headless restores.

v1.0

Initial release — save/restore desktop icon layouts across single or multiple monitors and resolutions, with monitor-signature matching and best-effort position remapping · align to grid, sort by name/type/date · icon size nudge · broken shortcut scanner · recover off-screen icons · layout version history, export/import · unified undo for layout, settings, and icon-size changes · auto-restore on display change, scheduled auto-save, run at Windows startup, global hotkeys · light/dark/system theme, adjustable icon spacing · system tray · tamper / decompilation detection.

Desktop Icon Manager · © 2026 Beeran Rampersad · All rights reserved